

UX approach

Research, design, and testing

How do you build a user experience?

User research

Who are the users and what problems are we solving for them?

- Talk to people - interviews, focus groups, surveys
- Review information - prior research, analysis, process documentation, data audit
- Synthesize - personas, journey maps, workflows, content models

Persona

DYNAMIC DISCLOSURE

Sylvia

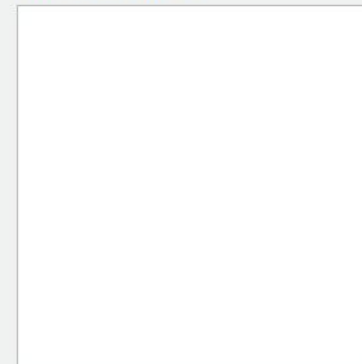
Sylvia, 27, is enrolling in a two-year medical billing program next month. She hadn't considered the profession until she read in a recruitment ad from a for-profit college that there are lots of jobs available in the field. Since she hates the part-time retail job she has now, and since she qualifies for tuition assistance from her husband's veterans' benefits, she figured why not. Yesterday, Sylvia got an email from the school she's going to telling her that, in order to be officially enrolled, she has to review some sort of financial aid disclosure. She follows the link in the email so she can get another step in her enrollment out of the way.

The page Sylvia lands on has a lot of information about her school and the aid package they offered her already filled in. She glances over the numbers to make sure they look right. She's a little surprised when she sees how high her monthly payments will be after she graduates, especially when she compares them to the average salary for medical billers (a lot lower than she thought, even if she beats the odds and actually graduates!) and to the rest of her living expenses.

After taking a few minutes to play around with her numbers and check out a few suggested options for taking on less debt, Sylvia feels like she has enough information and finishes her disclosure.

3 | Paying for College Aid Comparison Scenarios

AT A GLANCE



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Age: 27

School type: Private for-profit

Major: Medical billing

Degree type: Associate (two years)

MAIN GOALS

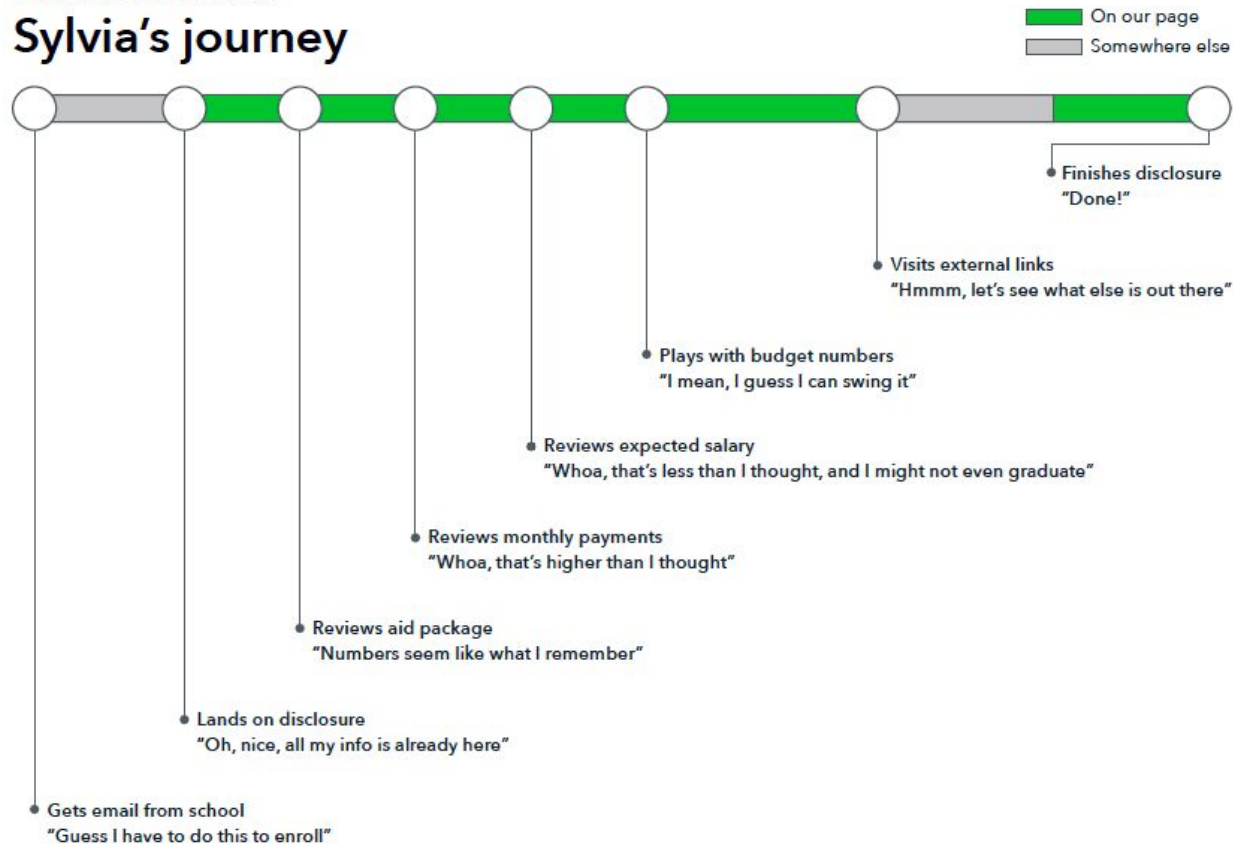
Hers: Complete this thing she has to do before she can enroll

Ours: Help Sylvia pause during a sometimes rushed enrollment process to consider the financial risks and rewards of attending her school with the aid package on offer

Journey map

DYNAMIC DISCLOSURE

Sylvia's journey



4 | Paying for College Aid Comparison Scenarios

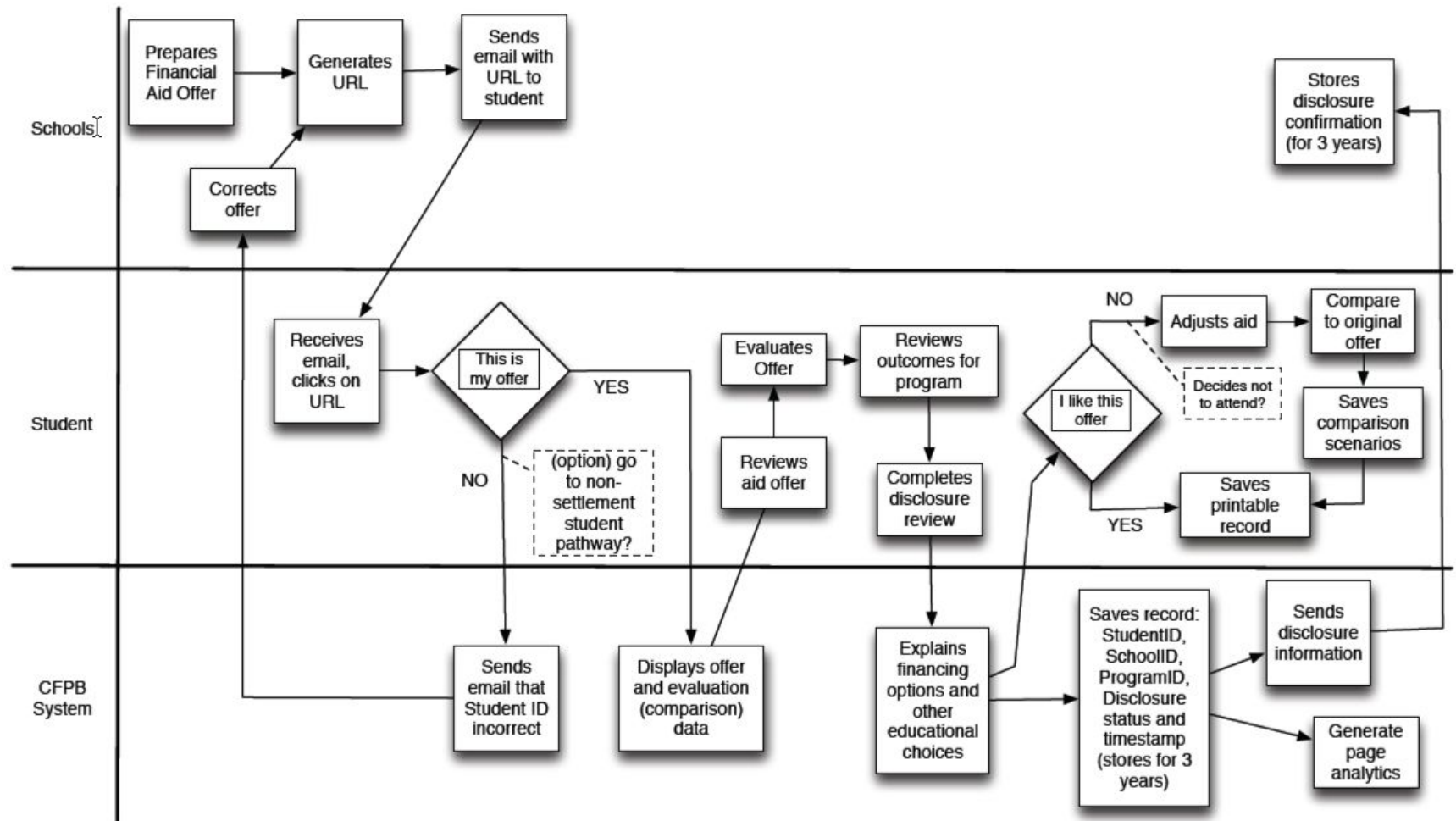
Content model

7. Job

All information in this content type will be used to auto-generate the job detail pages. There will be no CMS-managed instance of these pages, so will need to account for metadata within the content type.

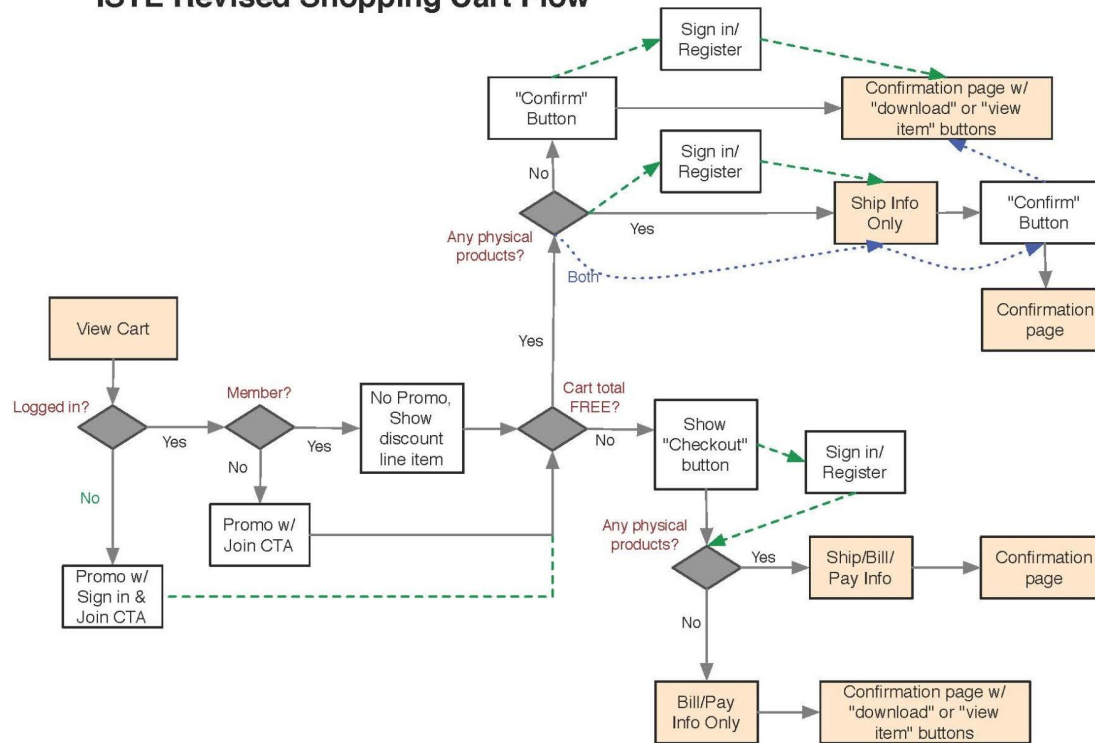
Job Content Type		
Field Name	Type	Description / Example
Job Title	Text	Title of job Used as H1 on page
City	Text	City where job is located
State	Pick List	Dropdown of states where job is located
Job Description	Rich Text	WYSIWYG content in CMS. Full overview description of product. No character count
Disclaimer	Rich Text	WYSIWYG content in CMS. (optional)
Metadata		
Page Title	Text	Used for default HTML title element.
Page Description	Text	Used for default HTML description meta tag.
Page Keywords	Text	Used for default HTML keywords meta tag.

Workflow chart - high-level



Workflow chart - detailed

ISTE Revised Shopping Cart Flow



Design

How can we improve what the users see and do by creating simple interactions and workflows?

- What's there - design studio, low-fi wires
- Where's it go - IA, adaptive grids, templates
- How things work - UI design, components, clickable prototype
- How things look - style guides, high-res wires, visual design

Usability testing

How do we know if what we're proposing is working?

- Test organization - card sort, tree tests
- Test efficiency - time-to-task, guided scenarios
- Test design - A/B testing, surveys, ratings scales

UX in the agile process

What does this look like for USTC?

Research

- Up-front research to understand system framework and high-level goals (50% understanding) - during first 2 sprints
 - Personas & journey maps for key user types
 - High-level workflow charts
- As we develop epics, look to what gaps we have to fill and talk to those users again (90% understanding) - 1-2 sprints ahead
 - Detail workflow charts
 - Content models

What does this look like for USTC?

Design

- After initial research
 - Map high-level IA and navigational patterns
 - Identify key workflows for small screen optimization
 - Evaluate design system for gaps
- After epic-related research
 - Wireframe the components/screens needed to build those stories
 - Apply visual design to those elements

What does this look like for USTC?

Usability testing

- After initial research
 - Test IA with organizational testing methods
- Once we have wire/design/code to test as output of user stories
 - Recruit appropriate users
 - Test!

Working together

- In tandem vs sprint ahead?
- Frequent team reviews to get input
- Best way to communicate design?
- Not worried about pixel perfect pictures
- When test with users?
 - Using code or wires/prototypes?

Did it work?

Measuring success of user experience

- Usability testing of end-to-end systems
- Follow-up surveys to users (internal and external)
 - Are things easier/faster? How?
 - Can you get the information you need?
- Analytics and tracking
 - How often is help content accessed?
 - How many cases are initiated but never completed?

Burning questions?